

Tzemach Tzedek Community Centre

Details and Notes for Purim 5784 (2024)

*Originally prepared by Rabbi Yosef Braun and sent out during his years as Rov of Tzemach Tzedek Community Centre.
Edited to suit times, dates and other details for this year.*

This year, with Purim starting on motzaei Shabbos 13 Adar II, the Fast day (Taanis Esther) is advanced to 11 Adar II (Thurs. 21 Mar.) The Megillah will be read on motzaei Shabbos and also in the daytime on 14 Adar II (Sunday 24 Mar.)

Purim is not so much about ancient history as about current life today and our avodah here and now. This is so important to actualise that if someone reads the Megillah thinking of the events only as ancient history, it is almost as though s/he has not fulfilled their obligation to read. So, don't be caught with your head in the wrong era!

Taanis Esther: 11 Adar II (Thurs. 21 Mar.)

- **Fast:** begins at *Alot Hashachar* (dawn), this year 5:41am. Shacharis and Mincha have the usual additions for a Taanis.
- **Mincha:** because of the additional components, Mincha starts at 6:40pm, a little earlier than the other days this week. *Machatzis Hashekel* before Mincha. This commemorates the half-shekel that was given annually during Adar when the Beis HaMikdash was standing. Three coins are given, each of them being half of the local currency. In Australia we may give three 50-cent coins.
- One must fast until Tzeis Hachochavim/ Maariv, this year at 7:30pm.

Shabbos Zachor and motzaei Shabbos: 13 Adar II (23 Mar.)

- **Shacharis:** starting at the usual time, 10:00am. (Note that the morning *Shema* is to be finished by 9:59am). Kiddush & farbrengen after Musaf, in honour of Shabbos Zachor.
- **Parashas Zachor:** It is very important that everyone – men, women and children – are in shule to hear the reading of the special parasha for Zachor. The time of reading will be at about 11:30am.
- **Shabbos Mincha:** early davening, starting at 1:30pm after a kiddush/ short farbrengen.
- **Motzaei Shabbos:** No earlier than 7:39pm, say "*Baruch hamavdil bein kodesh l'chol*" before doing any weekday activities or making any preparations for the evening.
- **Maariv:** at shule, starting at 8:10pm, followed by the Megillah at approx 8:25pm and then Havdalah. Additional Megillah reading at 9:45pm at the Lederman residence, 17 Anglesea Street Bondi.
- **Please note:** People who live close to Tzemach Tzedek are asked to walk there on motzaei Shabbos, so as to leave as much parking as possible for those who live further away and for those who need to drive.

Purim day: 14 Adar II (Sun. 24 Mar.)

- **Shacharis:** at 8:00am and 9:30am, with Megillah readings approx 30 minutes after each start time. Additional Megillah reading at 3:00pm at the Lederman residence, 17 Anglesea Street Bondi.
- **Mincha:** 4:00pm.
- **Purim Seudah:** We are required to make a feast during the day of Purim. It is customary to have eaten the main part of the meal by Shkia (7:01pm).
- **Maariv:** at Tzemach Tzedek, starting at 7:30pm.

General notes for Purim (motzaei Shabbos and Sunday)

- Megillah reading at Maariv and Shacharis is preceded by three brochos: al mikrah Megillah, she'asah nissim, and Shehecheyanu. When saying Shehecheyanu at Shacharis, one should also have in mind the mitzvos of mishloach manos, matanos l'evyonim and the Purim seudah. To read the Megillah, it is spread out like an old-style letter and gently folded three times. There are four pesukim that everyone reads aloud. The names of Haman's ten sons are read in one breath.
- Mishloach manos: On the day of Purim, every person is required to send two different foods to one other Jewish person of the same gender. Instead of spending many hours buying, packaging and delivering Mishloach Manos to numerous people, Tzemach Tzedek has made available 'PURIM DONATION CARDS' which you can send to people. They are available for various prices. The proceeds will go towards the Shule as well as assisting families in our community for Pesach. The cards will be available in shule from Benny Amzalak in advance and on Purim.
- **Please note:** One still has to give actual Mishloach Manos to one person in order to fulfil the mitzvah.
- Matanos La'evyonim: Every person is to give one present to each of two poor people. That is the minimum requirement; and it is proper to give more. A man may give a present to a poor woman. It is preferable to give generously to the poor, rather than to prepare a lavish Purim seudah or to give many portions (mishloach manos) to one's friends. Matanos La'evyonim can be arranged with Dovid Krinsky at Krinsky's Kosher Grocery, for distribution to those in need.

Shushan Purim: 15 Adar (Mon. 25 Mar.)

- No tachanun or tachanun-related sections in the davening.
- A person should add slightly to his joy and celebration during the meals of this day.

Sof Zeman Kiddush Levana for Adar II this year is on 15 Adar II at 4:35am Jerusalem time (Mon. 25/3 at 1:35pm Sydney Daylight Saving time).